

DVB-H technology is being piloted in the United States by Crown Castle and Nokia. The pilot has started in the Pittsburgh, PA, area and it aims to prove and test the feasibility of DVB-H technology and related service systems in the United States.

ETSI is responsible for the standardisation of information and communication technologies within Europe. It is made up of manufacturers, network operators, administrators, service providers, research bodies and users. Their acceptance of DVB-H as the standard for mobile TV paves the way for people to receive television-like content through a mobile phone.

An August 3, 2005, report by Techworld said the following about DVB-H:

“As if phones didn’t already have enough features, within the next few years, the mobile industry is going to add another major one: broadcast TV. The service will be consumer-led, but could there be other applications for business? The leading standard for mobile TV, DVB-H (Digital Video Broadcasting—Handhelds), has emerged from Nokia and been standardised by the European standards group ETSI, as EN 302 304.

DVB-H means building a new radio receiver into the handset, tuned to whatever spectrum is going to be used for mobile video broadcasting. It sends 15 Mbit/s of data per 8MHz channel, and adds error correction to compensate for possible poor reception.

Nokia has created DVB-H handsets—basically its 7710 device with an add-on radio module. Integrated DVB-H devices are due next year. Other handset makers including Samsung have prototypes and are expected to follow suit.

At first DVB-H will only be in expensive handsets. As time passes, it will become cheaper, until the DVB-H capability costs as little as adding an FM radio receiver.